

Chinese Automotive OEMs: Overseas Plants

Source notes behind the Transitions Lab piece China ships the factory, not just the car. Shared verbatim so readers can see the underlying research. Full article: transitionslab.org/insight-china-ships-the-factory.

Existing Factories of Chinese automotive companies abroad:

BYD:

Rayong, Thailand: production began in July 2024, with a designated annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles. Actual use is 30 per cent of designated capacity.

Camaçari, Brazil (a former Ford site): the Camaçari complex began assembling vehicles in July 2025. The annual capacity of operations is 150,000 electric and hybrid cars a year, which can be scaled up to double the amount. It is BYD's largest investment outside of Asia.

Szeged, Hungary: trial for passenger vehicle production started in January 2026, with full series production scheduled for Q2 2026 and an eventual capacity of about 200,000 vehicles a year. The company's first "Made in Europe" production.

Subang, Indonesia: BYD opened a second regional plant on September 3 with a capacity of 150,000 vehicles a year.

Great Wall Motor (GWM):

Tula, Russia: 500 million dollar investment with an annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles, producing since 2019.

Rayong, Thailand: annual capacity of 80,000 vehicles opened in June 2021 on a former GM site.

Iracemápolis, Brazil: converted from a Daimler plant acquired in 2021, with an annual capacity of 50,000 vehicles. Production started in August 2025.

Chery:

Barcelona, Spain (Ebro joint venture, former Nissan plant): Ebro holds 60% and Chery 40%. The partners have invested more than 150 million Euro and the plant could produce up to 200,000 vehicles annually.

Geely (through Volvo Cars):

Volvo is 78.7% owned by Geely Holding and runs plants in Torslanda, Sweden and Ghent, Belgium. The plant in Ridgeville, South Carolina (US) has installed capacity of 150,000 vehicles a year.

Planned investments of Chinese automotive companies abroad:

BYD:

Manisa, Turkey: construction of a plant with an investment of 1 billion dollar and annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles is on hold.

SAIC (MG):

Galicia, Spain: first factory in Europe, with a 200 million Euro investment, annual capacity of 120,000 vehicles. Start of operation in 2028.

Chery:

Lembah Beringin, Malaysia: industrial park to finish in 2027.

Barcelona, Spain: Chery wants to add capacity at its Barcelona joint venture.

Geely:

São José dos Pinhais, Brazil (Renault plant): Geely bought a 26,4% stake in Renault Brasil. The partners announced a joint investment of 3.8 billion R (real) at the Ayrton Senna complex to produce new car models.

Market shares of Chinese automotive companies across continents:

Europe: as of March 2026, Chinese automotive companies are set to cross the 4% market share barrier in Europe.

US: no percentages found in reports. Chinese manufacturers are largely shut out by high tariffs on Chinese imports.

South America (Brazil): the market share for electrified vehicles climbed to 25.2%.

Southeast Asia: Chinese OEMs reached about 15.7% of the ASEAN-6 market in H1 2026.

Sources and references

Every claim in the piece is backed by one of the numbered sources below. Shares vary across sources depending on how "Europe" is defined and which brands count as Chinese.

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